

OnePlus 15

Power over panache

Not too long ago, OnePlus was the brand everyone talked about. People genuinely believed OnePlus could compete with the big brands, and the hype was real. But lately, things have changed. According to the latest IDC report, OnePlus has been losing market share in India almost every quarter, and the brand clearly needs to do something different. The OnePlus 15 is that attempt at change. It was the first phone in India to launch with the Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 chipset, but rivals like the Realme GT 8 Pro and iQOO 15 have since arrived with the same processor. It has three 50-megapixel cameras and a huge 7,300 mAh battery. But OnePlus has also made some big changes. The Hasselblad partnership is gone, replaced by their own DetailMax engine. The popular alert slider has been swapped for a Plus Key.

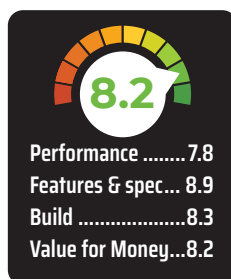
After around two weeks of daily use and testing, I'm here to break down whether the OnePlus 15 can help the brand get back on track, or if it's just another phone in a crowded market. Starting at Rs 72,999, it has a lot to prove.

DESIGN AND BUILD

First, let's talk about the design. The OnePlus 15 comes in three colours, and I got the Ultra Violet variant. It has a smooth matte finish that looks good and feels nice in hand. The colour has a subtle depth to it, not too flashy, but definitely eye-catching. The best part is that it doesn't pick up fingerprints, so I didn't have to wipe it down all the time.

The design looks like it follows the OnePlus 13s rather than the OnePlus 13. You get that square-shaped camera

₹72,999



module at the back, a flat frame with rounded corners, and an overall clean look. It's not trying too hard to stand out, and that works well.

Despite packing a much larger battery compared to the OnePlus 13, the phone stays pretty much the same size and weight. The OnePlus 13 weighs between 210-213 grams, depending on which version you get, and the OnePlus 15 is between 211-215 grams. OnePlus has clearly done a good job managing the internals, because fitting this much bigger battery without making the phone heavy is impressive.

One thing I do miss, though, is the alert slider. It's been replaced by a Plus Key that acts as a shortcut to perform various functions. While the Plus Key is fine, the Alert Slider was one of those small things that made OnePlus phones feel different.

When it comes to toughness, OnePlus has done really well. The phone has IP66, IP68, IP69, and the IP69K. That means the phone can handle everything from rain to high-pressure jets.

Overall, the OnePlus 15 has a good design, feels nice to hold, and can handle rough use.

DISPLAY

Let's talk about the display now. The OnePlus 15 has a 6.78-inch FHD+ LTPO OLED display with 1.5K resolution, Dolby Vision support and 120Hz adaptive refresh rate. Here's the interesting part, the refresh rate can go up to 165Hz while gaming. I'll tell you more about this in the performance section.

I tested the display using Calman and the SpectraCal C6 Colourimeter, and it recorded an average Delta E of 1.3, which is really good. The colours look accurate and lively when watching videos. The phone can also show a wide range of colours, with 99.6% gamut coverage in the sRGB colour space, which is excellent. During testing, the display reached 3,120 nits of brightness, which means you can easily see the screen even in bright sunlight.

So, the OnePlus 15 delivers a great display experience. Whether you're watching YouTube videos or streaming your favourite series, you'll get vibrant and immersive visuals every time.

PERFORMANCE

The OnePlus 15 runs on the Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 chipset, which looks powerful on paper but falls behind to its key rival. In AnTuTu testing, the phone scored 3,529,849, while the Realme GT 8 Pro achieved 3,963,689, even though both devices use the same processor. This shows how much optimisation matters. In Geekbench 6, the OnePlus 15 scored 3,609 in the single-core test and 10,680 in the multi-core test, again falling behind the Realme GT 8 Pro, which scored 3,666 and 11,050.